

CLASSIFIED EXPEDITION LOG

NORTH ATLANTIC — 25°N 71°W

◆ *Field Report No. 1*

Mystery of the Bermuda Triangle

One region. Five centuries of vanished ships and aircraft. No certain answers.

bermuda-triangle.report

Est. MCMXLV

What Is the Bermuda Triangle?

The Bermuda Triangle is a loosely defined region of the North Atlantic Ocean, roughly bounded by Miami, Bermuda, and Puerto Rico. It covers approximately 500,000 square miles of open water.

The name itself was coined by writer Vincent Gaddis in a 1964 magazine article, though reports of strange disappearances in the region stretch back to the 15th century, when Christopher Columbus reported unusual compass readings as he crossed this stretch of sea.

Area

~500,000 sq miles of open Atlantic Ocean

Name Origin

Coined by Vincent Gaddis, Argosy magazine, 1964

Earliest Record

Columbus, October 1492 — compass deviations logged

The Three Vertices

I VERTEX ONE Miami, Florida

25.7617° N, 80.1918° W — The western anchor. Gateway to the Atlantic.

II VERTEX TWO Bermuda

32.3078° N, 64.7505° W — The northern point. An island of mystery.

III VERTEX THREE Puerto Rico

18.2208° N, 66.5901° W — The southern apex. Edge of the Caribbean.



Five Centuries of Disappearances

1492

Columbus Reports Anomalies

Compass deviations and strange lights logged in the ship's journal.

1800

USS Pickering Vanishes

90 crew members lost without a trace en route to Delaware.

1918

USS Cyclops Disappears

306 crew lost — the largest non-combat loss of life in US Navy history.

1945

Flight 19 — The Lost Squadron

Five TBF Avenger torpedo bombers vanish during a routine training mission.

1948

Star Tiger — No Distress Signal

British South American Airways aircraft disappears without a trace.

Flight 19: The Lost Squadron

Five US Navy TBF Avenger torpedo bombers departed Fort Lauderdale on a routine training exercise. Two hours in, Flight Leader Lt. Charles Taylor radioed that his compasses were malfunctioning and the squadron was completely lost.

The aircraft never returned. A PBM Mariner rescue plane sent to find them also vanished. 14 airmen were lost in a matter of hours — no wreckage, no oil slick, no bodies ever found.

AIRCRAFT LOST

CREW LOST

WRECKAGE

6

14

None

USS Cyclops: 306 Souls Lost

The USS Cyclops, a Navy collier carrying 10,800 tons of manganese ore, departed Barbados in March 1918 bound for Baltimore. She never arrived. No distress signal was sent. No wreckage was ever found.

To this day, the loss of USS Cyclops remains the single largest non-combat loss of life in United States Naval history. President Woodrow Wilson remarked: "Only God and the sea know what happened."

"Only God and the sea know what happened to the great ship."

— President Woodrow Wilson, 1918

The Human Toll

1,000+

LIVES LOST

Documented fatalities over the past century of recorded incidents.

75+

AIRCRAFT LOST

Planes that vanished or crashed without explanation in the region.

100+

SHIPS VANISHED

Vessels of all sizes swallowed by this stretch of the Atlantic.

◆ PART II ◆

Theories & Explanations

From the mundane to the extraordinary — what might explain the disappearances that have baffled investigators for generations.

Human Error & Weather

The most widely accepted explanation among researchers and investigators: the Bermuda Triangle's disappearances are the result of ordinary human error, navigational mistakes, and extreme weather — not anomalous forces.

The region is one of the most heavily trafficked stretches of ocean in the world, crosses two major weather systems, and sits near the Gulf Stream — which can rapidly disperse wreckage and confound search teams.

Navigation Errors

Before GPS, the region's lack of landmarks made it extremely easy to become disoriented, especially for inexperienced pilots.

Waterspouts & Microbursts

Sudden violent weather events are common here. A waterspout can sink a vessel in minutes without warning.

Gulf Stream Dispersal

Moving at up to 5 knots, the Gulf Stream can carry and scatter wreckage hundreds of miles from the crash site.

Methane Hydrate Explosions

The seafloor beneath the Bermuda Triangle holds large deposits of methane hydrates — ice-like compounds that trap methane gas under high pressure. When these deposits destabilize, they can release enormous eruptions of gas.

A sudden methane eruption can dramatically reduce water density, causing ships to sink almost instantly without generating a distress signal. The gas cloud rising to the surface could also potentially disable aircraft engines flying overhead.

The Science

Australian scientists demonstrated in lab conditions that ships can sink in gas-saturated water without any conventional explanation.

The Caveat

Geological surveys have not confirmed active methane venting beneath the triangle in historical times, making this theory plausible but unverified.

Similar Craters Found

Massive craters on the Norwegian seafloor — attributed to methane blowouts — offer a plausible geological precedent.

Magnetic Anomalies

One of the oldest and most enduring explanations involves compass anomalies in the region. Columbus recorded this phenomenon in 1492. The Bermuda Triangle is one of only two places on Earth — the other being the "Devil's Sea" near Japan — where true north and magnetic north align.

This alignment, known as "agonic line," means compasses point to true north rather than magnetic north, eliminating the usual declination correction — potentially confusing navigators relying on standard adjustment calculations.



THEORY FOUR

Rogue Waves

Rogue waves — walls of water reaching 30 meters or more — were once dismissed as sailor myths. Satellite studies conducted since the 1990s confirmed they are real and far more frequent than models predicted.

The convergence of the Gulf Stream, Atlantic swells, and Caribbean storm systems in the triangle creates conditions where multiple wave trains interact — a known generator of rogue waves. A vessel struck by such a wave could sink within seconds.

MAX RECORDED HEIGHT

34 m

WARNING TIME

< 60 sec

Paranormal Theories

No survey of the Bermuda Triangle would be complete without the theories that fired the public imagination for decades. These explanations, while rejected by mainstream science, drove enormous popular interest in the mystery from the 1960s onward.

Charles Berlitz's 1974 bestseller "The Bermuda Triangle" sold 20 million copies and popularized many of these ideas. The book treated unverified accounts as documented fact — a distinction that matters enormously when evaluating such claims.

Lost City of Atlantis

Mysterious energy crystals from the sunken civilization, allegedly interfering with navigation and electronics.

Alien Abduction

Extraterrestrial spacecraft using the ocean floor as a base of operations, harvesting vessels and crews.

Time Portals & Wormholes

Dimensional rifts that transport ships and aircraft to other time periods or alternate dimensions.

What Science Says

Lloyd's of London — the world's primary maritime insurance market — does not charge higher premiums for ships crossing the Bermuda Triangle. This is perhaps the most telling data point: the world's foremost risk analysts see no elevated danger.

The US Coast Guard does not recognize the Bermuda Triangle as a particularly hazardous area. Statistical analyses consistently show the region's disappearance rate is not significantly higher than any other area with similar traffic volume.

Researcher Lawrence David Kusche's 1975 book "The Bermuda Triangle Mystery: Solved" examined every reported incident and found that many were fabricated, embellished, occurred outside the region, or had conventional explanations that were omitted from popular accounts.

LLOYD'S OF LONDON

"No additional premium is charged for vessels crossing the Bermuda Triangle."

US COAST GUARD

"The Coast Guard does not recognize the existence of the Bermuda Triangle as a geographic area of specific hazard."

◆ *Final Entry*

The Triangle Endures

The evidence suggests the Bermuda Triangle is less a zone of supernatural danger and more a mirror of human psychology — our need to find pattern and meaning in randomness. The ocean is vast, indifferent, and occasionally lethal.

The triangle's true mystery may be why we need it to be mysterious at all.

"The sea, once it casts its spell, holds one in its net of wonder forever."

— Jacques Cousteau